Chao (Charles) Cheng

School of Finance, Zhongnan University of Economics and Law
Wuhan 430073, China

charlescheng1992@gmail.com
charleschenggithub.github.io
github.com/CharlesChengGithub

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Finance (expected), Zhongnan University of Economics and Law 2023–2027
Advisor: Jinlin Zhang

M.Econ. in Finance, Hainan University 2020–2023

B.Eng. in Information Security, Hefei University of Technology 2011–2015

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Economics of artificial intelligence; Computational economics (agent-based models, reinforcement learning); Behavioral finance and futures markets; Household finance and policy evaluation

PAPERS UNDER REVIEW

1. "When Artificial Intelligence Generates and Experts Validate: Specialist Allocation and the Aggregate Substitutability of Artificial Intelligence in Research" (with Jinlin Zhang). *Revise and resubmit, Systems*.
2. "Do Below-Cost Sales Bans Facilitate Algorithmic Collusion? Price Floors, Learning and Cost-Based Regulation". *Under review, Computational Economics*.
3. "Cost-Based Price Floors, Soft Budgets and Capacity Adjustment in China's Solar Photovoltaic Industry" (with Jinlin Zhang). *Revise and resubmit, Sustainability*.
4. "When Pilots Overlap: Contamination Bias in Difference-in-Differences Evaluations of China's City Pilot Policies" (with Jinlin Zhang). *Revise and resubmit, Sustainability*.
5. "Who Gets Liquidated? Margin Requirements and the Reallocation of Liquidation Risk in Futures Markets: An Agent-Based Systems Analysis" (with Jinlin Zhang). *Revise and resubmit, Systems*.

WORKING PAPERS

1. "Fleeing or flocking? Generative AI and the demand for college majors in China". *Working paper*.
2. "Generative AI Adoption and Back-Office Employment: Early Evidence from Chinese Listed Firms". *Working paper*.
3. "Holding Losers: Bias or Patience? The Disposition Effect, Trading Function, and Pricing Efficiency in Futures Markets" (with Jinlin Zhang). *Working paper (in Chinese)*.
4. "Closing a Position Does Not Cut the Link: Profit Feedback, Sequential Participation and Cross-Market Risk in Futures Markets". *Working paper (in Chinese)*.
5. "Do Managers Underreact? Subjective Uncertainty and the Revision of Range Earnings Forecasts". *Working paper*.
6. "The Efficiency and Equity of Trade-in Subsidies: Evidence from the China Household Finance Survey". *Working paper (in Chinese)*.
7. "Housing Space, Purchasing Capacity, and the Upgrading of Household Durable Goods: Evidence from the China Household Finance Survey" (with Jinlin Zhang). *Working paper (in Chinese)*.
8. "Monitoring and Early Warning of Systemic Financial Risk: The Evolution of Methods and Their Applicability in China". *Working paper (in Chinese)*.

BOOKS

1. *Agent-Based Modeling in Economic Research: From Introduction to Practice*. *Book manuscript (in Chinese)*.
2. *Capital Markets and Common Prosperity: Wealth Creation, Distribution and Governance* (with Jinlin Zhang). *Book manuscript (in Chinese)*.

RESEARCH PROJECTS

- Major Program of the National Social Science Fund of China, "Financial Theory and Effective Mechanisms for Advancing Common Prosperity" (22&ZD115), participant; related output: the book *Capital Markets and Common Prosperity*

SKILLS

Programming	Python (agent-based modeling, reinforcement learning, simulation), Stata, LaTeX
Data	China Household Finance Survey (CHFS), futures brokerage account data, listed-firm annual reports and CSMAR, gaokao admission data
Languages	Chinese (native), English (CET-6, 538)

Last updated: October 2026